o: Director Brim-Edwards, Director DePass, Director Sullivan
Re: Kindergarten Start Date
March 17, 2025

TAGAC believes, as you do, that to provide the best support possible for students' growth and well being, every student's needs must be met where they are. Sometimes that means waiting to start kindergarten, sometimes that means starting a bit early. We are cognizant of the problems surrounding this issue, from the potentially wide age range in a classroom to the deep financial cuts that are happening, not to mention that early academic readiness can often be shaped by privilege.

Although historically a relatively small population of families request early entry to kindergarten, it is an important issue - it is highly impactful to those families and those children. These children's needs should not be forfeited because the birthday cut-off is arbitrary, or because there could be a spread of just over a year between students in a classroom, or because some families might enter their child early to save money.

While we defer to your expertise as to the specific date that is best for entry cutoff, we know that delaying the annual cutoff date is key to allowing flexibility for children who are best supported by early entry. Therefore, we support Director Brim-Edward's suggestion of Sept 30th as the new cutoff date. In addition, regardless of what date is chosen, families need help determining if their child is ready for kindergarten, which would benefit PPS as well. To that end we suggest:

- Provide information on what PPS expects of entering kinders socially/emotionally and for classroom skills readiness.
- Literature for parents on how to support and assess a younger kindergartener during the school year.
- Accredited culturally competent checklists of readiness.
- A suggestion to discuss readiness with the child's pediatrician.
- Support in finding alternative placements.
- Sending all of this directly to all families with September and late summer birthday children.

Thank you,

Jessica Colby, TAGAC co-chair